8.4.1 Unidimensional Binary Search

To recap what we have described in section 8.2, it's easy to perform binary search when our entries can lie on unidimensional space: the entries can be translated to points on a line (that’s basically a unidimensional space) and each point on that line implicitly defines a left and a right.

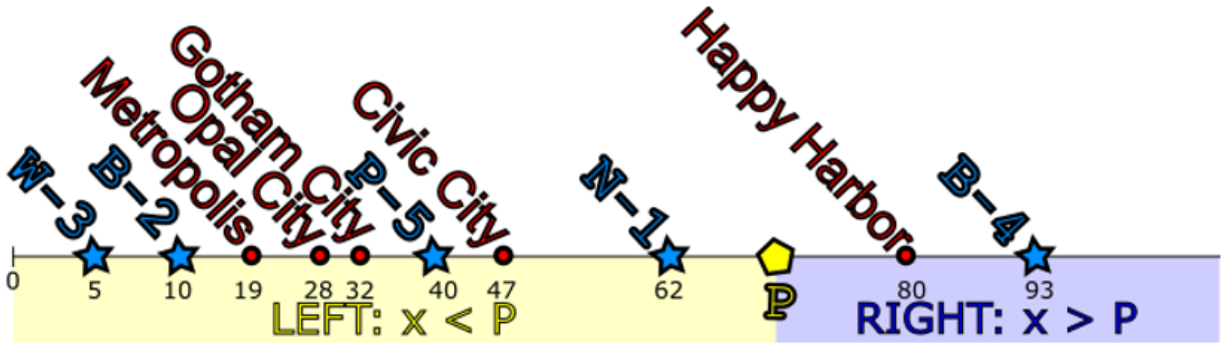


Figure 8.7 Real numbers on ℝ. Given a point P, the continuous line is naturally partitioned into a left (yellow) and a right (blue) subset.

So, each node has a value that corresponds to a point on that line, and each point on the line defines a left and right. But wait, in a binary search tree we also have left and right paths for each of our nodes: that's why it's was so easy to know what to do, in binary trees search!

8.4.2 Moving to Higher Dimensions